Congresses

H 1460

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A. Background

The free-floating subdivision ***--Congresses*** is used under subjects for collections of conference proceedings on those subjects as well as for works about congresses on those subjects. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for the use of ***--Congresses*** as both a form and topical subdivision. For classification of congresses, see F 240.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Congresses as a form subdivision

Use ***--Congresses*** as a form subdivision under subjects of all types to represent either: (1) the collected papers delivered at, or published on the occasion of, one or several congresses, symposia, conferences, meetings, etc.; (2) condensations or abstracts of such papers; (3)

reports of the proceedings or discussions, preprints, program statements, lists of delegates, etc., of such congresses; or (4) combinations of these types of materials.

LC practice: Record subject heading(s) for the topic of the conference(s). Use the LCGFT *__Conference papers and proceedings__* for published records of conferences, including abstracts, reports, and the papers presented. Use LCGFT **__Conference materials__** for ephemeral materials such as flyers, program books, daily newsletters, or newspapers that are distributed at conferences.

D. Meetings of a society or institution or institution

For the proceedings of a meeting or meetings of a society or institution on a specific subject, use the subdivision **__--Congresses__** under the subject. For the annual meeting of a corporate body or other proceedings dealing with the internal affairs of a society or institution, use the subdivision **__--Congresses__** under the name of the corporate body, society, etc.

LC practice: Record subject heading(s) for the topic of the meeting or the corporate body that is hosting the conference for its internal affairs. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. *__Conference papers and proceedings__* and **__Yearbooks__**.

E. Lectures published separately

Use the form subdivision **__--Congresses__** for collections of two or more lectures or papers, or of contributions, essays, etc., that are based on papers, originally presented at a conference or meeting and identified with that meeting. Omit the subdivision **__--Congresses__** when one or several lectures, originally delivered on the occasion of an individual meeting, are later published under separate cover, and no longer identified with the original meeting.

LC practice: Record subject heading(s) for the topic of the lectures, papers, etc., that are based on papers, originally presented at a conference or meeting and identified with that meeting. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. *__Conference papers and proceedings__* and **__Lectures__** and/or **__Essays__**.

F. Legislative hearings

Do not use the subdivision **__--Congresses__** for the hearings of legislative bodies.

LC practice: Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. **__Legislative hearings__.**

*G. Use of form subdivisions after *--Congresses**

Further subdivide ***--Congresses*** by the form subdivisions ***--Calendars***, ***--Directories***, or ***--Juvenile literature***, if appropriate. Do not use the form subdivisions ***--Abstracts*** or ***--Periodicals*** after the subdivision ***--Congresses***.

LC practice: Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. ***Conference papers and proceedings*** and ***Directories***.

E. --Congresses as a topical subdivision

Use ***--Congresses*** as a topical subdivision under subjects for works about congresses, conferences, meetings, etc., on those subjects.

Example:

```
Title: The guide to writers conferences.
   650 #0 $a Authorship $x Congresses $v Directories.
```

LC practice:

```
   650 #0 $a Authorship $x Congresses.
   655 #7 $a Directories. $2 lcgft
```

Example:

```
Title: ERIC calendar of education-related conferences.
   650 #0 $a Education $x Congresses $v Calendars.
```

LC practice:

```
   650 #0 $a Education $x Congresses.
   655 #7 $a Calendars. $2 lcgft
```

F. The subdivision –Congresses--Attendance

Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Congresses--Attendance*** under subjects for works on attendance at or participation in congresses on those subjects.

Example:

```
Title: Conference attendance patterns among physicists.
   650 #0 $a Physics $x Congresses $x Attendance.
   650 #0 $a Physicists $z Great Britain.
```

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.